

Commander Navneet Bali,
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This World Health Day Prioritize Preventive Healthcare to Lead a Healthy Life

An initiative of the World Health Organization, World Health Day is observed annually on the 7th of April to draw attention to pertinent health topics of concern to people all over the world. Thus to mark the occasion we conversed with Commander Navneet Bali, Regional Director - North, Narayana Health on how one should look at health checkup differently for a better health. One of India's largest multi-speciality hospital chains, Narayana Health offers a combination of innovative technology & extremely efficient delivery infrastructure. In this interview, Commander Bali undertakes to create awareness and importance of preventive healthcare.

For the uninitiated, what is preventive healthcare? And why is it of significance?

When the word healthcare is used, the associated image that mostly comes to mind is of people getting sick, going to the hospital and being treated. Now, what if we shift the emphasis on wellness rather than illness – which not just helps individuals stay healthier but also reduces the burden of illness on our economy. So, we take a step back and instead of focusing on treatment, zero in on prevention. One way of doing that is by following a healthy lifestyle, which involves good nutrition and exercise. But there are a lot of changes that happen in the human body that one may not be aware of. When we go for annual health checkups, we place ourselves in the position of finding out the signs of an anomaly at its initial stages itself. That way we could cut down the risk of the disease reaching its advanced stages.

If we want to turn into a healthy nation and not spend our hard-earned money on tackling illnesses, then every individual in the family must undergo annual routine health checkups.

A lot of people show reluctance towards preventive health check-ups. Their fear strangely stems from becoming aware of the ailments they might be suffering from. Becoming aware of the disease instead puts them at a better chance of fighting it. What would your message be in response?

Let's say a family adopts the habit of getting annual health checkups done. Experts suggest that for those who are young, the basic tests get conducted. Height and weight measurements are taken to calculate the BMI and benchmark against age standards. Blood tests get prescribed to check the levels of hemoglobin, white blood cells and platelets count. Urine collection is done to find out about kidney health. Blood Pressure Readings, fasting blood sugar and post prandial blood sugar tests are conducted to acquire information about diabetes.

For people having crossed 40 years of age, Physicians recommend some more tests, such as Chest X-Ray, ECG, Sonography of Abdomen, and Lipid Profile among others. In the case of most of these tests, if the reports do not fall within the prescribed range, by making changes to the lifestyle and dietary habits they can be brought under control. In most cases, medications prescribed at early stages could help one bring the measurements back on track.

For men older than 50 years, Doctors could prescribe PSA tests. While, in the case of women in that age bracket, screening for breast and cervical cancer is important. Apart from physical self-examination of the breasts, experts also recommend routine or annual mammography and pap smear.

There is nothing to fear about these tests. Even if the reports show variation from normal parameters, it means one has detected a disease at its early or developing stage and thus has a stronger chance of overcoming it.

People can combat this inhibition o preventive checkups when year after year, they along with their families undergo annual routine tests. As it becomes part of the routine, the fear goes away. People get at their disposal longitudinal data, in which an aberration when discerned can be administered early treatment.

How would you describe the facilities offered by Narayana Health when it comes to preventive health check-ups?

Our hospitals in Katra, Gurugram and Delh offer array of health checkup packages. They are custom made to suit the requirements of both men and women. The categorization is also made based on age & specific needs. These packages are extremely affordable because we want people to make annual routine checkups a part of their habits. At Narayana Health, our vision is of making contributions toward building a healthy nation. And we view these preventive health checkups as a major step in that direction. Under Section 80D of the Income Tax Act, individuals who undergo preventive health check-ups can enjoy tax deductions of up to INR 5000 per financial year.

We also provide on-demand tests, say

Dharamshila Narayana Superspeciality Hospital, Delhi

Narayana Hospital Gurugram

Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Narayana Superspeciality Hospital, Jammu